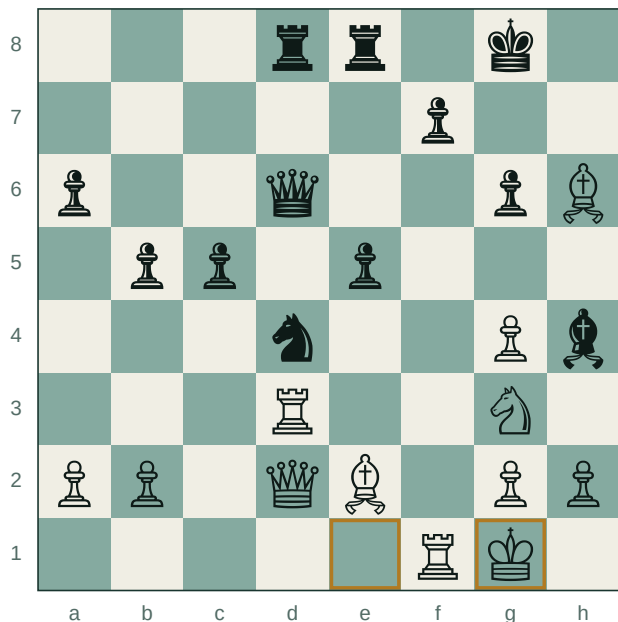


Discovered attacks: Black, move 23

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 23.O-O. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Nxe2+ 24. Qxe2 Qxd3 25. Qxd3 Rxd3

23...Nxe2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and knight on g3. Recorded reply: **24.Qxe2**.

24...Qxd3 The queen captures the rook on d3. From d3 it attacks queen on e2 and knight on g3. Recorded reply: **25.Qxd3**.

25...Rxd3 The rook captures the queen on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.